Urgent Executive Wire Authorization Request — BEC Incident

Incident: BEC-FRAUD-2026-09 | Classification: Business Email Compromise (Social Engineering)

Message Interception & Header Analysis

Enterprise email security filters intercepted a high-priority executive impersonation message targeting the corporate treasury department. The sender spoofed the Chief Executive Officer's name using an external lookalike domain and demanded an urgent out-of-band wire transfer.

Email Header Details: Date: October 14, 2026 07:44 AM EST From: Arthur Vance, Chief Executive Officer To: Elena Rostova, Senior Director of Corporate Treasury Priority: HIGHEST / TIME-SENSITIVE / STRICTLY CONFIDENTIAL Subject: URGENT: Acquisition Earnest Deposit Wire ($485,000 USD)

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Body Transcript Excerpt: "Elena, I am currently in closed-door executive arbitration regarding our strategic acquisition of a European logistics partner. Due to strict regulatory confidentiality covenants under European financial law, this transaction CANNOT be disclosed to other staff or processed through normal procurement channels at this stage. You must immediately execute an earnest deposit wire transfer in the amount of $485,000 USD to our appointed escrow agent prior to 11:00 AM EST today. Bypass the standard dual-authorization verification protocol for this single wire. I will personally provide retroactive sign-off tomorrow."
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Extracted Fraud Indicators & Entities

Indicator Value	Type	Threat Context	Status
ceo-office-direct@corporate-holding[.]example[.]org	Email	Spoofed Executive Sender Address	Malicious
corporate-holding[.]example[.]org	Domain	Lookalike Adversary Domain	Malicious
escrow-liaison@acquisition-holdings[.]example[.]org	Email	Fraudulent Escrow Advisor	Malicious
acquisition-holdings[.]example[.]org	Domain	Bogus Holding Company Domain	Malicious
Global Merger Escrow Holdings Ltd (Acct: 9948-2819-0021)	Financial	Mule Bank Account Destination	Fraudulent

MITRE ATT&CK; & Fraud Tactics

- **T1656 (Impersonation)**: Impersonation of executive leadership to bypass standard controls.
- **T1566.002 (Spearphishing Link / Narrative)**: Coercive psychological pressure and artificial urgency.
- **T1598 (Spearphishing for Information / Authorization)**: Attempted fraudulent funds diversion.

Immediate Fraud Prevention Actions

1. **Payment Halt**: Confirm that zero wire transfers have been released to account 9948-2819-0021.

2. **Out-of-Band Verification**: Contact CEO Arthur Vance via documented corporate telephone directory.

3. **Mail Gateway Blacklist**: Add corporate-holding[.]example[.]org and acquisition-holdings[.]example[.]org to tenant blocklists.

4. **Treasury Alert**: Reiterate mandatory dual-custody verification policy across all treasury and accounting personnel.

Triage Assessment: HIGH SEVERITY (Score: 8.4 / 10.0)